CLAUDE IMPACT LAB · SEATTLE

crumbs

AI for neighborhood food shops, and the neighbors who love them.

Every review leaves crumbs.



Small food shops are flying blind

25 of 38

Washington owners surveyed name marketing a top time sink

16 of 38

worry about customer data and privacy when using AI

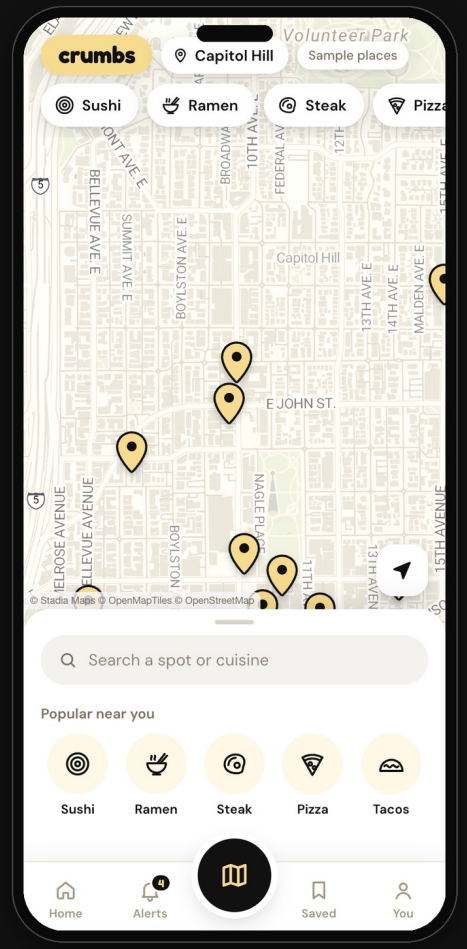
94.5 vs 98.5

Washington small-business optimism vs the U.S. (NFIB, winter 2026)



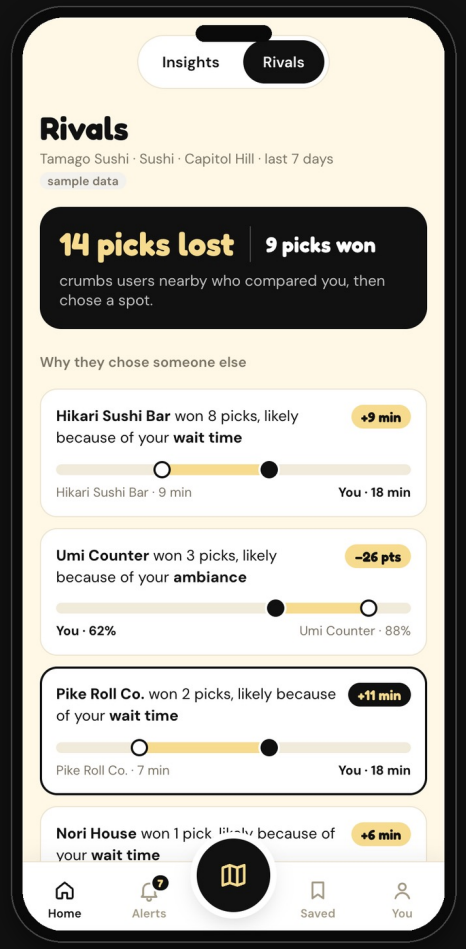
Sources: hackathon survey of 38 Washington owners (multi-select); NFIB Small Business Economic Trends, Washington, Winter 2026

One product, two sides



For neighbors

Pick a food, see every nearby spot scored side by side, and get a walking route to the winner.

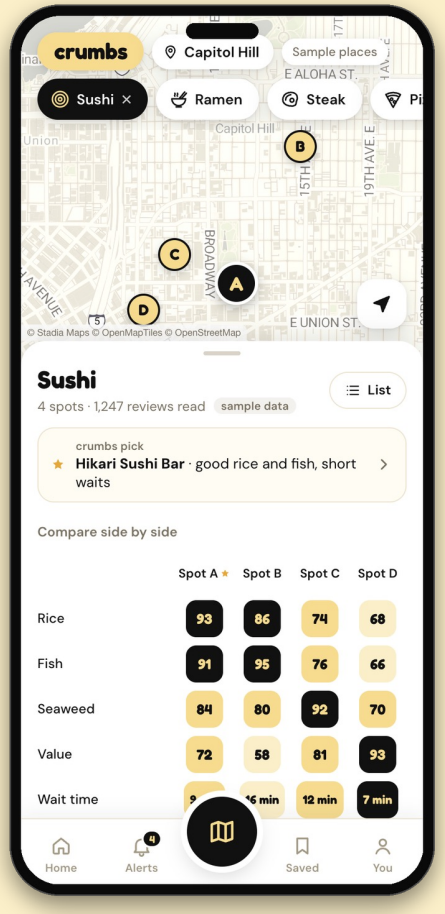


For owners

See how you stack up, which rivals diners pick over you and the likely reasons, and get alerts when something changes nearby.

Screens show sample data

Honest picks, built from real reviews



Claude reads the reviews

One call per spot scores each attribute from 0 to 100, from review text only.

Never guessed

If no review mentions it, the score stays blank. We do not invent a number.

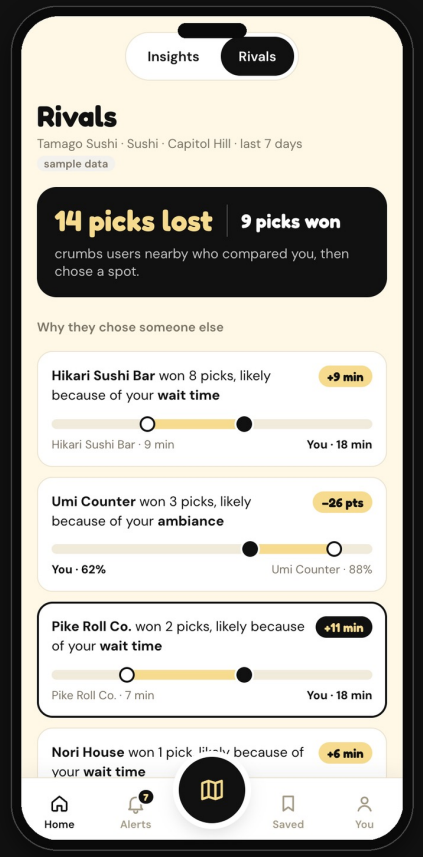
Waits are real minutes

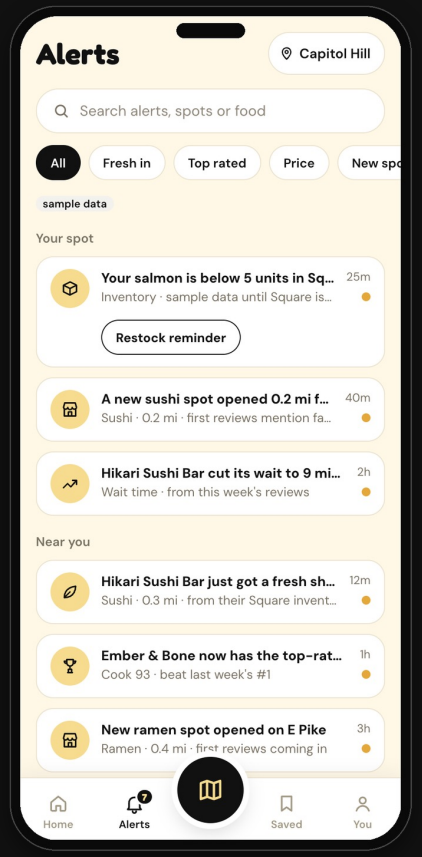
We take the minutes reviewers actually state, and compute the median in code, not with the model.

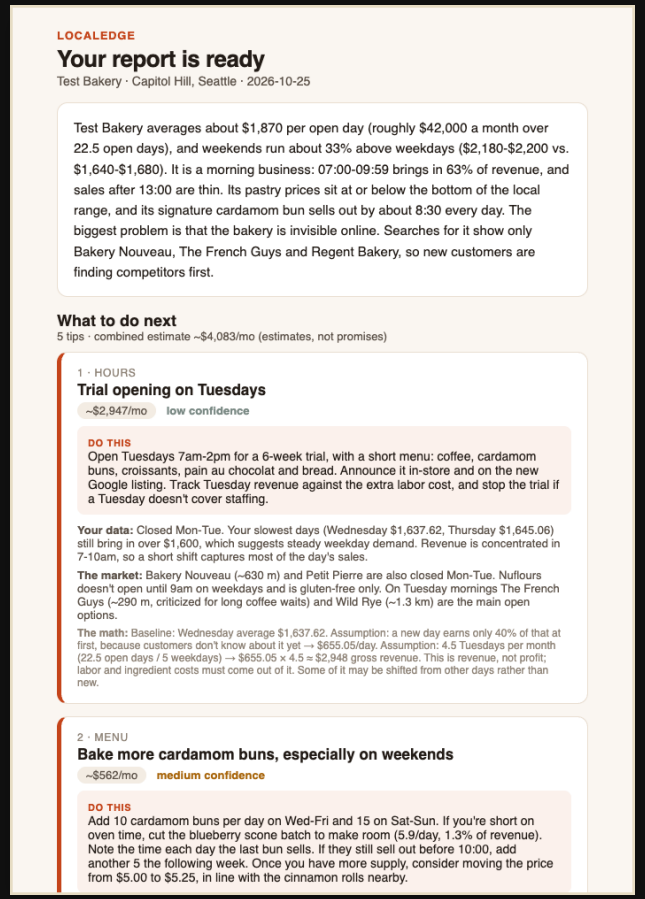
The pick is transparent

Highest average score wins. Ties go to the spot with more reviews read.

Owners get answers, not dashboards







Rivals
Picks lost, and the likely reasons

Alerts
Rival changes and low stock in one place

Report email
The full advice, in one inbox

One practical step to test

MENU · SAMPLE BAKERY REPORT

Bake more cardamom buns, especially on weekends

Do this

Add 10 buns a day Wed–Fri and 15 on Sat–Sun. Note when the last one sells. If they still sell out before 10:00, add 5 more the next week.

From the shop's own sales

About 40 buns a day, with the last one sold around 8:30. The limit is what gets baked, not what customers want.

From the market

No nearby rival sells a cardamom bun. Comparable buns cost $5.25 to $7.86+.

Shown with its math

Assumes only 5 of the 10 extra buns sell: 5 × $5.00 × 22.5 days.

≈ $562 a month

estimated revenue, not profit · confidence: medium

From the sample bakery report (sample sales data). Illustrative estimates; we have not run this experiment.

Under the hood: agents in parallel

Owner
name, area, sales (optional)

Advisor · under a minute

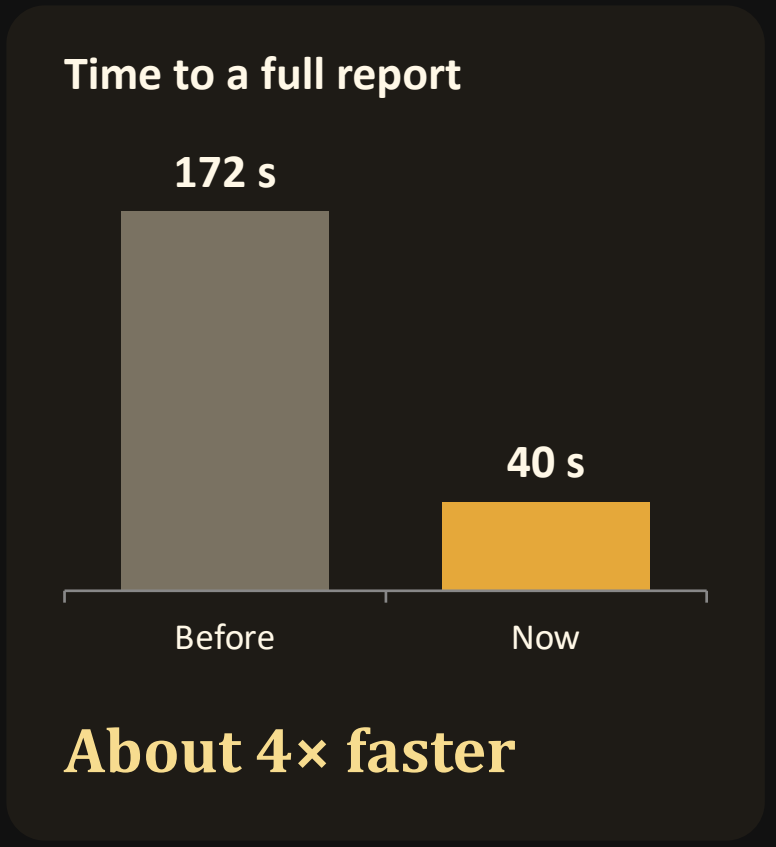
- 1 agent per competitor, up to 8, all at once
- The owner's own online presence
- Product gaps and review trends

Tailored advice

Delivered as

- App
- Report email
- Text or email alerts

GitHub Actions monitor · Mon / Wed / Fri · re-check rivals, compare, alert



Measured on one sample bakery over a few runs: 172 s before, about 40 s now.

Built to be trusted

Sources on every claim

Each competitor entry carries the links it came from, so owners can check the evidence.

Never guessed

Missing data stays blank and is listed as a caveat. Without sales data, dollar estimates are left out.

Private by design

Picks are stored anonymously: no user id, IP or device. API keys stay on the server.

Safe email

One recipient per report, HTML-escaped, rate-limited, with no tracking links.

Why it matters, and what's next

696K

small businesses in Washington, employing 1.5 million people

Their optimism trails the nation, 94.5 vs 98.5. Local shops need every edge they can get.

Next: a local-owner pilot

We will measure

1. Research time saved
2. Recommendations owners act on
3. Outcomes of the experiments they choose

We're looking for Seattle food-business owners to help shape crumbs.
Proposed: a monthly subscription per location (price not set).

Source: NFIB Small Business Economic Trends, Washington, Winter 2026

Thank you

crumbs is open source: github.com/RuthGajj05/crumbs

J

Jagger

Front-end development, testing

N

Neha

API integration, web scraping, report emails, pitch deck, testing

R

Ruthwika

Web scraping, connecting front-end and backend, testing

B

Boong

Web scraping, pitch deck, business solutions, testing

M

Manny

Back-end and scaffolding, testing

Every review leaves crumbs.